

AGRISENSO Plus Survey — Enumerator Field Guide

2026-09-18 · @Someone

For the enumerator and supervisor training workshop. Covers Instrument A (AGRISENSO Plus borrowers) and Instrument B (non-borrower comparison group).

1. How long an interview actually takes

Plan 90 minutes for Instrument A and 75 minutes for Instrument B per completed interview, plus travel and time spent locating the respondent.

These figures come from the instrument itself. Every question each respondent type is actually asked was counted by replaying the app's own routing rules, then costed at face-to-face pacing.

Instrument A — AGRISSENTO Plus borrowers

Respondent	Questions asked	Brisk	Typical	Slow
Individual crop farmer, loan released, reported shocks and insurance	185	58 min	102 min	173 min
Individual crop farmer, no shocks, insurance or training	165	52 min	92 min	157 min
Organisational trader, loan not yet released	133	43 min	76 min	129 min

Instrument B — non-borrower comparison group

Respondent	Questions asked	Brisk	Typical	Slow
Individual crop farmer, applied and was declined	149	47 min	83 min	140 min
Individual crop farmer, never applied	129	42 min	74 min	125 min

Respondent	Questions asked	Brisk	Typical	Slow
Organisational trader, never applied	100	33 min	58 min	98 min

Brisk means a cooperative, literate respondent and an enumerator fluent in the dialect, with no interruptions. **Slow** means an elderly or low-literacy respondent, translation, difficulty recalling amounts, or an organisational respondent leaving to check records. Use **typical** for planning.

The 30–45 minute target is not achievable

Settle this with ACPC and DRVN before fieldwork rather than discovering it in the barangay.

Instrument A asks an individual borrower about 165 questions on the shortest realistic path. At even ten seconds each — faster than possible for the 24 questions asking for a peso amount, area or volume — that alone is 28 minutes, before the consent script, the six matrix grids, or any rapport. The floor for a full Instrument A interview is roughly 50 minutes.

This matches comparable instruments, which run 60 to 120 minutes, and matches the reviewer's own warning in the fifth comment batch that the target "may be difficult to achieve."

Three options, in the order we would recommend them:

1. Revise the stated length to 90 minutes for A and 75 for B, and adjust daily quotas and the enumerator payment basis to match.
2. Shorten the instrument. Section C alone is 18 minutes; that is where the minutes are if the study can accept less detail on production scale, output disposition and post-harvest losses.
3. Split Instrument A across two visits for organisational borrowers, who most often need to consult records.

What the routing already saves

Commodity-based routing measurably shortens the interview for respondents who are not crop or livestock producers.

	Questions asked	Shorter by
Instrument A, trader vs. full farmer path	133 vs. 185	29%

	Questions asked	Shorter by
Instrument B, trader vs. full farmer path	100 vs. 149	35%

An enumerator who ticks activities carelessly in C1 loses this saving and adds twenty minutes. Emphasise C1 in training.

Caveat

The question counts are exact. The per-question pacing is an informed estimate, not measured. **Time six to eight real interviews during the pilot with a stopwatch**, record the respondent type for each, and replace these figures with measured ones before setting quotas.

2. What the app does and does not do

The app is a data-collection form that saves to Google Sheets. It is not a case-management system and it does not validate anything against LANDBANK records.

What it does for you

- Skips questions that do not apply, and says on screen which earlier answer caused the skip.
- Fills in the questionnaire version, version date and control number by itself.
- Works out the Final Eligibility Determination (A10) from your screening answers.
- Derives Age Group from age, and Island Group from region.
- Records interview date, start time and end time automatically.
- Adds up percentage columns and warns when a total exceeds 100.
- Warns when answers contradict each other, such as dependants exceeding household size.
- Keeps working with no signal, and saves answers on the device as you go.
- Stops the interview when a routing rule says it must stop.

What it does not do

- It does **not** check the respondent against the LANDBANK borrower list. Borrower type, segment, name and sampling-frame ID are whatever the enumerator enters. Verifying them against the approved list is a human step, on paper, before the interview starts.
- It does **not** flag a wrong-but-plausible number. Typing 5 hectares instead of 0.5 is accepted silently.

- It does **not** allow two interviews in progress on the same instrument on one device. Starting a second Instrument A interview before finishing the first means losing the first.
- It does **not** upload anything until the device has a connection. "Sync Pending Now" is what sends queued interviews.
- It has **no login**. Anyone opening the link can submit a response, so the device itself must be controlled.

Known rough edges to mention in training rather than let people discover

- Province, municipality and barangay dropdowns are fetched from an online government directory. With no signal they stay as plain text boxes. That is expected. Type the names carefully, exactly as printed on the sampling frame.
- The region list carries all 18 regions, not only the study clusters.
- Enumerator and supervisor names are free text unless the approved roster has been loaded into the app. Agree one spelling convention at the workshop, for instance **De la Cruz, Juan M.**, and hold everyone to it.

3. Before the first interview

Do all of this before leaving for the barangay, while there is still signal.

On the device

1. Open the survey link once with a connection so the questionnaire downloads. It will not open cold with no signal the first time.
2. Confirm the chooser screen shows both Instrument A and Instrument B.
3. Confirm there is no leftover draft. If opening an instrument asks whether to resume a saved response, that is a previous interview — resolve it with your supervisor before starting a new one.
4. Charge the device. A 90-minute interview with the screen on is a real battery load.

On paper, in hand

- The approved sampling frame extract for the day, showing for each respondent: sampling-frame ID, name, borrower type, borrower segment, and barangay.
- A printed copy of the consent script, as a fallback if the device fails mid-interview.
- The supervisor's contact number, for the cases the app tells you to refer.

Decide before you start, not during

The single question that shapes the whole interview is **A2 — borrower or respondent type** (individual, or organisational/enterprise). Read it off the sampling frame. Getting it wrong sends the interview down the wrong branch, and correcting it later clears the

answers that no longer apply.

The second is **C1 — current agricultural or enterprise activities**. Tick only what the respondent genuinely does. Every extra tick adds a block of production questions.

One device, one interview at a time

The app holds one in-progress response per instrument. Finish and submit before starting the next. If an interview must be abandoned part way, submit it rather than leaving it open — the outcome field records why.

4. Running the interview, section by section

Section C is the longest block in both instruments at roughly 18 minutes. If an interview is running late, it is already late by the end of Section C.

Both tables below are for the most common case: an individual respondent on the typical path. Times cover the questions only — greeting, consent and closing are listed separately at the foot of each table.

Instrument A

#	Section	Items asked	Budget
2	Questionnaire Administration	8	3 min
3	Introduction and Informed Consent	4	1.5 min
4	Borrower Identification and Eligibility Screening	14	4 min
5	Borrower and Household / Organization Profile	16	6 min
6	Farm, Fishery, and Enterprise Profile	36	18 min
7	AGRISENSO Plus Awareness and Access Experience	6	3.5 min
8	AGRISENSO Plus Loan Agreement Profile	30	11.5 min
9	Loan Utilization and Financing Adequacy	11	7 min
10	Financial Knowledge and Capability	14	6 min
11	Borrower Experience, Assessment, Suggestions	18	6 min
12	Enumerator Final Review	5	2 min
13	Enumerator Observation / Interview Notes	2	1 min

#	Section	Items asked	Budget
14	Closing Statement	1	0.5 min
	Questions total	165	69 min
	Greeting, rapport, consent script, closing, sync		+23 min

Instrument B

#	Section	Items asked	Budget
2	Questionnaire Administration	8	3 min
3	Introduction and Informed Consent	4	1.5 min
4	Identification and Eligibility Screening	13	4 min
5	Respondent and Household / Organization Profile	16	6 min
6	Farm, Fishery, and Enterprise Profile	35	18 min
7	AGRISENSO Plus Awareness and Application Experience	5	3 min
8	Current Financing Needs, Sources, Access Barriers	10	4 min
9	Financial Knowledge and Capability	15	6.5 min
10	Perceptions of AGRISSENSE Plus and Agricultural Financing	6	2 min
11	Future Financing Intentions and Suggestions	9	4 min
12	Enumerator Final Review	5	2 min
13	Enumerator Observation / Interview Notes	2	0.5 min
14	Closing Statement	1	0.5 min
	Questions total	129	53 min
	Greeting, rapport, consent script, closing, sync		+21 min

Pacing rules for the enumerator

- **Read the consent script, do not paraphrase it.** It is the legal basis for the interview and takes three to four minutes. Build it into the plan rather than rushing it.

- **Check the clock at the end of Section C.** Past 35 minutes into the interview at that point, the visit will run to two hours. Tell the respondent, and offer to continue or arrange a callback.
- **Use the Sections button** in the footer rather than pressing Previous repeatedly. It lists all 14 sections with how many questions are answered in each and what is still outstanding.
- **Watch the answered count** in the header. It shows only the questions that apply to this respondent, so it is a real progress measure.
- **Do not read out greyed sections.** They do not apply. The line beneath each says why.

5. The rules the app enforces

Only 15 questions are compulsory. Everything else may be left blank, because a respondent is entitled to decline any question.

Questions marked * — the page will not advance without them

These are the consent and eligibility gates. They are the same count in both instruments, but the item numbers differ, which matters when supervisors check work.

	Instrument A	Instrument B
Language used	Yes	Yes
Interview mode	Yes	Yes
Consent to participate	Yes	Yes
Consent to be re-contacted	Yes	Yes
Enumerator attestation	Yes	Yes
Region (A1)	Yes	Yes
Borrower / respondent type (A2)	Yes	Yes
Loan agreement verification (A5)	Yes	Yes
Loan release status / previous loan (A6)	Yes	Yes
Application status (A7)	—	Yes
Individual eligibility	A7.1–A7.3	A8.1–A8.2
Organisational eligibility	A8.1–A8.2	A9.1–A9.2
Age (B2)	Yes	Yes

Only the branch that applies is required. An individual respondent is never asked the organisational eligibility questions, and the reverse.

Filled in by the app — do not type over these

Field	Where it comes from
Questionnaire version and version date	Set by the app
Questionnaire control number	Generated per interview, unique to the device
Final Eligibility Determination (A10)	Calculated from the screening answers
Age Group	Calculated from age
Island Group	Calculated from region
Interview date, start time, end time	Recorded automatically
Percentage totals	Added up from the rows above

Field	Where it comes from
Supervisor Verification	Opens at "Pending" — supervisor updates it, not the enumerator
Data Verification Status	Opens at "Pending verification"
Back-check Status	Opens at "Not yet selected"

If A10 reads "Not yet determined", a screening question above it is still unanswered. Scroll up rather than looking for somewhere to type the answer.

When the app stops the interview

A red panel appears, Next is disabled, and the only way forward is **End interview and submit this record**. This is deliberate. Submitting the stopped record is how the case is counted in the sample disposition — do not abandon it.

Instrument	Trigger	What it means
Both	Consent to participate = No	Thank the respondent and close. Recorded as refused.
A	Loan agreement verification = No	Not an AGRISENSO Plus borrower. Refer to supervisor.
A	Loan agreement verification = Unable to verify	Stop and refer for validation before any substantive questions.
A	Respondent under 18	Cannot be interviewed. Arrange a replacement.
A	Organisational representative not authorised	Find an authorised representative or book a callback.
B	Currently has an AGRISENSO Plus loan	Belongs in the borrower sample, not the comparison group.
B	Previously had an AGRISENSO Plus loan	Not eligible for the comparison group.
B	Respondent under 18	Cannot be interviewed. Arrange a replacement.
B	Organisational representative not authorised	Find an authorised representative or book a callback.

Call the supervisor the same day for any stop other than a refusal. Most of them need a replacement respondent drawn from the sampling frame.

6. Recording answers correctly

The most damaging habit is entering a filler answer instead of the accurate one. "Don't know", "Prefer not to answer", "None" and a genuine skip mean four different things in the analysis and must not be collapsed into one.

Which one to record

Situation	What to do
Respondent does not know or cannot recall	Choose "Don't know" or "Unable to estimate" if the question offers it, otherwise leave blank
Respondent declines to answer	Choose "Prefer not to answer" if offered, otherwise leave blank
The true answer is zero or nothing	Enter 0 , or tick "None". Never leave blank
The question does not apply	The app greys it out. Do not look for a way to answer it
You forgot to ask	Go back and ask. Do not guess

Do not type "N/A" into a text box. If a question genuinely does not apply, the app has already skipped it.

Amounts, and the mistake that was reported from the field

Production cost, gross sales, net income and household income each offer two routes: an exact peso amount, or a fallback such as "Unable to provide exact amount" followed by a bracket.

Always ask for the exact amount first. Only offer the brackets if the respondent cannot give a figure.

If you tap a fallback by mistake, you can still type the amount — the box stays open and choosing one route clears the other automatically. An earlier version locked you out after a mis-tap; that is fixed. Every single-answer question also now has a **Clear answer** link beneath it.

Net income accepts a negative number for a genuine loss. Record a loss as a negative figure rather than as zero — zero reads as break-even.

Numbers

- Never leave a numeric box showing a stray digit. Blank means not answered; 0 means zero.
- The app warns when values contradict: economically active members or dependants above household size, cultivated area above total area, amount released above amount approved. **A warning is not a block.** Re-ask the question, and only keep the figure if the respondent confirms it.
- Record the unit the question asks for. Areas use the single unit chosen once for both area questions.

Select-all questions

- Read every option aloud before accepting an answer. This is why they take longer.
- "None" and "Not applicable" clear the other ticks automatically, because they contradict them.
- "Other" opens its specify box only when ticked. Write what the respondent said, not a category.

Questions built from earlier answers

Some questions list back exactly what was ticked earlier: the most significant difficulty, the shock with the greatest effect, the principal activity. If one shows "Answer C1 first" or similar, the earlier question is unanswered. Go back — do not skip it.

Greyed-out questions

A greyed question carries a line saying which answer skipped it, for example *"Skipped — your answer to A2. Borrower Type (Organizational / enterprise borrower) means this does not apply."*

If a question is greyed and you believe it should not be, that line names the answer to correct. Do not try to force the question open.

7. Saving, working offline, and syncing

Answers are saved on the device continuously. They are not on the server until the interview is submitted **and** synced.

The normal flow

1. Answers save to the device as you tap. No action needed, no signal needed.
2. **Submit Response** at the end of the last section.

3. With signal, the response goes to Google Sheets and a response number is shown.
4. With no signal, it is queued on the device and the message says so.
5. Back in signal, open the instrument and press **Sync Pending Now**. The chooser screen also shows how many responses are waiting.

Sync before the end of each field day. A queued response only exists on that one device.

Two ways data has been lost, and how to avoid them

Answering "Cancel" on the resume prompt. Opening an instrument with a saved response asks whether to resume it. Cancel starts a blank form and **the saved answers are gone**. Read that prompt every time. If unsure, choose resume — you can always leave and come back.

Starting a second interview before submitting the first. There is one draft per instrument per device. Beginning a new Instrument A interview while another is in progress overwrites it. Finish and submit first.

Practical rules

- Never hand the device to another enumerator mid-interview.
- Never clear browsing data or site data. That erases queued responses.
- Use the same device and the same browser for the whole assignment.
- Leaving via **Menu** is safe — progress is kept and can be resumed.
- A submitted response cannot be edited in the app. Corrections go to the supervisor, who edits the Sheet.

If the device fails mid-interview

Fall back to the printed questionnaire, finish on paper, and encode it later the same day. Do not re-interview the respondent.

8. Supervisor responsibilities

The three quality-control fields are the supervisor's, not the enumerator's. An enumerator marking their own interview verified defeats the control.

The quality-control fields

They sit at the end of the questionnaire, in Enumerator Final Review, and open at a safe default.

Field	Opens at	Who changes it
Supervisor Verification	Pending	Field supervisor, after reviewing the record
Data Verification Status	Pending verification	Data manager
Back-check Status	Not yet selected	Supervisor, once a back-check is assigned

Back-check Status offers: Not yet selected, Selected for back-check, Completed, Unable to complete, Not selected.

Interview Outcome

The enumerator records this at the end, and it is how the sample disposition is built. Choosing "Callback required" or "Respondent unavailable" opens callback date, time and notes.

When the app ends an interview through a routing gate it sets the outcome itself — refused, ineligible, partially completed or callback required, depending on the rule.

Daily supervisor checks

1. Every enumerator has synced. No responses left queued on a device overnight.
2. Response count in the Sheet matches the count of interviews reported.
3. Every stopped or refused case has been reported, and a replacement respondent drawn where needed.
4. Spot-check three records against the sampling frame: sampling-frame ID, borrower type, segment, name.
5. Check Final Eligibility against the screening answers on any record that looks unusual.
6. Check for zero-heavy records. A run of zeros across amounts usually means fillers rather than real values.

Weekly

- Set Back-check Status on the sample selected for back-check.
- Review interview durations. Anything far below the section-4 budget is worth a conversation; a 35-minute Instrument A interview did not ask every question properly.
- Confirm enumerator name spellings are still consistent in the export.

Corrections after submission

Submitted responses cannot be edited in the app. Corrections are made in the Sheet by the supervisor or data manager, with a note of what changed and why. Never ask an enumerator to submit a second record for the same respondent — it creates a duplicate with its own response number.

9. Suggested workshop agenda

Two days. The single most valuable hour is the full-length timed mock interview on day two — it is the only way anyone believes the 90-minute figure.

Day 1 — the instrument

Time	Session
60 min	Study background, sampling frame, who is in Instrument A and who is in B
45 min	Informed consent: read the script aloud, practise it, discuss refusals
45 min	Eligibility screening and the stop rules. Walk every row of the table in section 5
60 min	Section C in detail: activities, principal activity, areas, production, costs
45 min	Amounts: exact figure first, brackets second, recording a loss, correcting a mis-tap
30 min	Blank vs. "Don't know" vs. "Prefer not to answer" vs. "None" vs. skipped

Day 2 — the app

Time	Session
30 min	Device setup, opening the survey, resuming and the Cancel trap
45 min	Guided walkthrough of Instrument A on the trainer's screen

Time	Session
90 min	Timed mock interview in pairs, Instrument A, full length, stopwatch running
30 min	Debrief: compare actual times against the section-4 budget
45 min	Timed mock interview, Instrument B, organisational respondent
45 min	Stop-rule drills, working offline, syncing
30 min	Supervisor session: quality-control fields, daily checks, corrections

Practice scenarios

Run each as a pair exercise. The point of the first four is that the app should stop the interview.

1. **Refusal.** Respondent declines consent. Expect the stop panel; submit the record.
2. **Not a borrower.** Instrument A, loan agreement verification = No. Expect the stop and a supervisor referral.
3. **Wrong sample.** Instrument B, respondent turns out to have a current AGRISENSO Plus loan. Expect ineligibility.
4. **Unauthorised representative.** Organisational respondent who cannot answer for the organisation. Expect a callback.
5. **The trader.** Individual borrower whose only activity is trading. Confirm the farm-production blocks collapse, and note the shorter interview.
6. **Mixed farmer.** Crop production and livestock and trading. Note how much longer it runs — this is the C1 lesson.
7. **The mis-tap.** Tap "Unable to provide exact amount" on gross sales, then have the respondent recall the figure. Enter it and confirm the fallback clears.
8. **Declines income.** Household income refused. Record "Prefer not to answer" and do not force a bracket.
9. **Loss-making enterprise.** Net income is a loss. Record it as a negative amount, not zero.
10. **No signal.** Switch the device to airplane mode, complete an interview, submit, then reconnect and sync.

What every enumerator should be able to do before leaving

- Read the consent script without paraphrasing it.

- Say what A2 does to the rest of the interview.
- Name the four different ways of recording a non-answer.
- Recover from a mis-tapped single-answer question.
- Explain what a greyed question means and where to look for why.
- Submit a stopped interview rather than abandoning it.
- Sync a queued response and confirm it reached the Sheet.

10. Limitations to state plainly

Say these at the workshop rather than letting people discover them in the field.

Open, and waiting on someone else

Item	Blocked on	Field effect today
Enumerator and supervisor rosters	Approved name list from DRVN / LANDBANK	Free text. Agree a spelling convention and hold to it
Sampling-frame ID validation	LANDBANK borrower list	Format is checked, the ID itself is not. Verify on paper
Borrower type and segment pre-loading	LANDBANK borrower list	Enumerator classifies from the printed frame
LANDBANK lending-centre list	LANDBANK	Free text
Region list narrowed to study clusters	ACPC	All 18 regions shown
Enumerator guide (.docx in the repo)	Rewrite	Out of date. This document supersedes it

Not yet proven in the field

- **The app has not been used in a real interview.** It has been tested thoroughly, including a full pass through every section of both instruments, but the pilot is still the first real test.
- **One path could not be reproduced during fixing.** A field report said Instrument B question A8 would not accept answers. Testing could not reproduce it, and two plausible causes were fixed: the eligibility gate was genuinely wired to the wrong questions for Instrument B, and skipped questions now explain themselves. **Test both branches of A8 and A9 in Instrument B during the pilot** and report what happens.

- **Location dropdowns depend on an online directory.** They work when tested, but behaviour on a live published site with weak rural signal is unproven. The fallback to plain text is proven.

Before the pilot

1. Redeploy the app. Several fixes are in the backend, not only the website, and deploying one without the other leaves two versions running.
2. Take a copy of the Google Sheet. This revision adds columns.
3. Load the enumerator and supervisor rosters if available.
4. Run two test interviews per enumerator and delete the rows afterwards.

Set expectations on scope

This instrument measures what respondents report. It does not verify loan records, amounts or production against any external source. Where a figure matters to the study's conclusions, the analysis should say it is self-reported.